

Q1



Directions for questions 1 to 5: Read the following passages and answer the questions that follow them.

Books by tennis stars are a rarity in India. After Vijay Amritraj's *An Autobiography*, which he penned in 1990 with the assistance of English journalist Richard Evans, it was 23 years before Nirupama Vaidyanathan came up with a refreshing *The Moonballer*, coincidentally launched in Chennai by Amritraj. On the occasion, Amritraj had remarked, "knowing how difficult it is in India for any athlete in any sport to do well, for Nirupama to come up and spearhead an era of women excelling in sports, be it a Sania Mirza or a Saina Nehwal and many others, was great."

Now, Sania Mirza, the affable Hyderabad and national tennis icon, presents her journey in the form of a delightful autobiography aptly titled *Ace against Odds*. Co-authored by her father Imran Mirza and journalist Shivani Gupta, the book is an account of the hardships and triumphs that finally propelled her into the league of big tennis.

The intense scrutiny she was subjected to by a prying, and sometimes uncharitable, media is something she fought to handle. And this strong persona resonates from the book. In person, though, she looks cool and casual, in a plain white top with ripped jeans, hair open and big hoops in her ears. "It wasn't something that happened over a year; the idea came to me about six or seven years ago. I was asked about it a lot of times but it did not happen earlier because I was not ready then. It was all about when to release it and I wanted to say it my way, in my words. Also, a lot was happening on and off the court. I'm glad I finally got it done, she says.

The autobiography, with a lively foreword by Martina Hingis, recounts Mirza's journey with minute details embellishing the memorable moments of her career. "I am happy and honoured to call her my partner and a friend for life," Hingis raves about the woman who inspired a legion of young pony-tailed aspirants in India to take to tennis.

Which of these options aptly summarizes the third paragraph of the passage?

- ☒ a) The strong persona of Sania Mirza, who fought to handle the uncharitable remarks showered upon her by the media, is echoed in her autobiography. She says that the delay was caused because she wanted to do it in her own way. (Your answer - ✖)

- ☐ b) Sania Mirza, the national tennis icon is the latest in penning an autobiography, titled *Ace Against Odds*, that too in a country where books by tennis stars are a rarity.
- ☐ c) Sania Mirza, a casual looking, cool kind of person, has always been subjected to intense scrutiny by the media. But she has always fought her way through.

- ☐ d) The idea of penning an autobiography in her own words has been there in Sania Mirza's mind for the past six or seven years. She, who always has been a strong persona in front of the prying media, is finally content that the autobiography is done, that too in her own way. (Correct Answer - ✔)

Solution:

Options B and C do not capture all the important details of the paragraph. Both options (A) and (D) - try to summarize the paragraph, including the key points, though, (D) is more appropriate. The para gives more importance to her mulling over the idea of writing down the autobiography. (A) gives more importance to her "strong persona" factor.
Choice (D)

According to the passage who has 'spearheaded an era of women excelling in sports', in India?

☒ a) Sania Mirza (Your answer - ✖)

☐ b) Saina Nehwal

☐ c) Nirupama Vaidyanathan

☐ d) Vijay Amritraj

Solution:

It is clear from the first para of the passage that Nirupama Vaidyanathan was the person who has spearheaded an era of women excelling in sports.

Choice (C)

Which of these statements is true, according to the passage?

☐ a) Books by stars are a rarity in India.

☒ b) Books by tennis stars are a rarity in India (Your answer - ✔)

☐ c) Books by sports stars are a rarity in India

☐ d) Books by tennis stars are aplenty in India.

Who among these has/ have co-authored Sania Mirza's book?

1. Nirupama Vaidyanathan
2. Imran Mirza
3. Shivani Gupta
4. Vijay Amritraj

- ☐ a) Only (1)
- ☐ b) Only (2)
- ☐ c) (1) and (2)

☒ d) (2) and (3) (Your answer - ✓)

Hinges has remarked Sania Mirza as "the woman who inspired a legion of young pony-tailed aspirants in India", in

- ☐ a) an interview given to New York Times.
- ☐ b) her own autobiography.
- ☐ c) a social-networking site.

☒ d) the foreword in Sania Mirza's autobiography. (Your answer - ✓)

Directions for questions 6 to 10: Read the following passages and answer the questions that follow them.

Fantasy has the longest and richest literary heritage of all the forms of genre fiction. Indeed, fantasy could be said to be the progenitor of all other forms of storytelling. Fantasy's habit of taking real – life situations and characters and introducing them into a world where unexpected (and unexplainable) things happen has enthralled its readers since the earliest days. If we look at the history of literature, it is full of stories involving magic, paranormal phenomena and terrible monsters. Such stories existed in spoken (oral literature) forms, long before the advent of printed literature. It is also a fact that fantasy and realistic fiction co-existed and a great many realistic stories first played out in a fantastical form in the author's mind before being written down in a realistic form. Adventures, magic, gods, heroes, and troubles overcome with a touch of the supernatural, etc, were very common in many tales of yore.

Interestingly, the very early recorded literary works in history were fantasy works: *the Epic of Gilgamesh*, Homer's *Odyssey*. *The Book of a Thousand and one Nights* and countless others were the prototypes upon which modern literature was formed. Many of the most enduring works of popular and literary fiction fall squarely within the realm of fantasy, such as Sir Thomas Mallory's *Le Morte D' Arthur*, Rudyard Kipling's, *The Jungle Book* and Sir Walter Scott's *Ivanhoe*. Despite this, fantasy today has an image of being a genre literary inconsequence. It has to be borne in mind that Lewis Carroll's books *Alice's Adventures in Wonderland* and *Through the looking Glass*, for instance, have defied description since they first were published over 100 years ago. The books were unquestionably written for a child – the original Alice, who was the daughter of a friend of Carroll's – but they are just as often read by adults looking for an escape back to a simpler time.

Fantasies allow the reader to circumnavigate and speculate on central and sometimes painfully realistic themes in a way that is more palatable than in realistic fiction or art. The fantastic nature of characters and settings removes readers to an emotional distance that gives them room to consider sensitive and important ideas more objectively than in other genres. To be precise, fantasies provide great escapes from reality, and paradoxically they also provide objective insights into reality which are won by means of looking at it through the unrealistic lens of impersonalisation. An irony about fantasy is that despite the fanciful characters, strange imaginary lands, and bizarre situations encountered in it, it has the power to help us better understand reality.

Which of the following adjectives is most suitable to refer to the tone of the passage?

- ☐ a) Caustic
- ☐ b) Humorous
- ☐ c) Satirical

☒ d) Descriptive (Your answer - ✓)

Why does fantasy literature enthrall its readers?

- ☐ a) Because it's full of stories involving super natural elements.
- ☐ b) Because, fantasy has the longest and richest literary heritage of all forms of the genre fiction.
- ☒ c) Because of fantasy's habit of taking real life characters and events and placing them in a supernatural world, where unexpected things could ensue. (Your answer - ✓)
- ☐ d) Many of the most enduring books in the history of literature belong to this genre.

In the last sentence of the first para, the expression, "tales of yore" indicates

- ☐ a) tales of gods.
- ☒ b) tales based on myths. (Your answer - ✗)
- ☐ c) stories of the contemporary.
- ☐ d) stories or tales told in the past.

Solution:

'Of yore' refers to the time period. It implies that whatever is considered to be "of yore" belongs to the past or to an earlier period of time.
Choice (D)

Which one of these is not a prototype upon which modern literature was formed?

- ☐ a) Le Morte D'Arthur (Correct Answer - ✓)
- ☐ b) Epic of Gilgamesh
- ☐ c) Homer's Odyssey
- ☒ d) The Book of a Thousand and one Nights (Your answer - ✗)

Solution:

(B), (C) and (D) are mentioned as the prototypes on which modern literature was based, but not option A.
Choice (A)

According to the passage, which of these statements is true, regarding Alice's Adventures in Wonderland?

☐ a) It was written after 'the book through the Looking Glass' was published.

☐ b) It was written for the original Alice, the daughter of one of Carroll's friends. (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) It was first published more than a decade ago.

☒ d) It finds favour both with adults and children. (Your answer - ✗)

Directions for questions 11 to 15: Read the following passages and answer the questions that follow them.

The introduction of English education in India was inseparable from the process of subjection/ subjectification under colonialism. The colonial "subject" was indeed constructed through practices or technologies of power/knowledge. One such apparatus of control was 'translations'. British rule over India lasted for about two centuries. However, in 1793, when the proposal for English education for the natives was put before the parliament, the Board of Directors held wide consultations before shooting down the proposal. Twenty years later, it was agreed that "such measures ought to be adopted, as may tend to the introduction among them [natives of India] of useful knowledge and of religious and moral Improvement". Slightly later, in the 1835 Minute on Indian education, Macaulay, who was an avid reader of history, claimed he had not found a single Orientalist "who could deny that a single shelf of a good European library was worth the whole native literature of India and Arabia". Trevelyan, Macaulay's cousin, also agreed with him whole-heartedly that Indian knowledge was "worse than useless".

As Gauri Viswanathan has pointed out in her meticulously researched essay, "The Beginnings of Literary Study in British India" the introduction of English education can be seen as "an embattled response to historical and political pressures: to tensions between the English Parliament and the East India Company, between parliament and the missionaries, between the East Indian company and the native elite classes". Tejaswini Niranjana extended Vishwanathan's argument to suggest that the specific resolution of these tensions through the introduction of English education was enabled discursively by the colonial practice of translation. She says: "European translations of Indian texts prepared for a Western audience provided to the 'educated' Indian a whole range of Orientalist Images. Even when the anglicised Indian spoke a language other than English, 'he' would have preferred, because of the symbolic power attached to English, to gain access to his own past through the translations and histories circulating through colonial discourse. English education also familiarized the Indian with ways of seeing, techniques of translation, or modes of representation that came to be accepted as 'natural'."

The introduction of English education in India was inseparable from

- ☐ a) the process of immigration under colonialism.
- ☒ b) the process of subjection/ subjectification under colonialism. (Your answer - ✓)
- ☐ c) the process of manipulation under colonialism
- ☐ d) the process of industrialization under colonialism

The “apparatus of control” mentioned in the passage refers to

- ☐ a) colonialism.
- ☐ b) subjection.

☒ c) translation. (Your answer - ✓)

- ☐ d) documentation.

The passage depicts that the British were ----towards Indian knowledge and literature. Fill in the blank with the suitable adjective, that depicts the attitude of British towards Indian literature.

☐ a) contemptuous (Correct Answer - ✓)

- ☐ b) sceptic
- ☐ c) contemplative
- ☐ d) emotional

Solution:

In the first paragraph, the attitude or opinion of Macaulay and Trevelyan provided, evidently implies that they were not full of respect or were positive towards Indian literature. On the contrary, they looked at it scornfully. 'Contemptuous' refers to the feeling that something is worthless.
Choice (A)

In the passage, what has been referred to as “an embattled response to historical and political pressures” in India?

- ☐ a) The colonial practice of translation.
- ☐ b) The publication of Macaulay’s Minutes.
- ☒ c) The introduction of English education. (Your answer - ✓)
- ☐ d) The subjection of natives through technologies of power.

Who has commented about the Indian knowledge as “worse than useless”?

- ☐ a) Macaulay
- ☐ b) Gauri Viswanathan
- ☐ c) Tejaswini Niranjana

☒ d) Trevelyan (Your answer - ✓)